

Chapter 7

The alley was pitch black, and the air was filled with a different atmosphere.

As if a fight would break out the next second.

Ji Jingrong's phone was in her hand, and a notification lit up the screen.

For Yin Lingzhu, this bit of light was like a lifeline.

She seized this opportunity and fiercely kicked toward Big Brother's abdomen, using one hundred percent of her strength.

The power of an S-level Alpha was not to be underestimated.

Big Brother was unprepared and was directly kicked to the ground. He clutched his stomach and leaned against the wall, unable to get up for a long time.

Hearing the sound, Little Brother weighed the pros and cons.

He directly turned on his flashlight and picked up a stick to hit Ji Jingrong.

Yin Lingzhu saw this too, but she couldn't push Ji Jingrong away in time, so she could only use her body to block in front of her.

The stick had been in the alley for a long time. Yin Lingzhu felt sharp pain in her arm, and the wood broke directly.

Little Brother hadn't expected this scene either. He dropped the stick and tried to run.

The moment he turned around, Yin Lingzhu quickly kicked him in the back of his knee, and Little Brother knelt on the ground.

She dragged Little Brother to Big Brother's side, making them lean together.

After doing all this, Yin Lingzhu turned to check on Ji Jingrong's condition.

She found that Ji Jingrong still maintained her previous posture, as if she hadn't reacted yet, standing there in a daze.

Yin Lingzhu waved her hand in front of Ji Jingrong to check her condition.

Ji Jingrong suddenly came back to her senses and saw a pair of slender, fair hands waving.

Through the previous conversation, she could roughly understand what had happened.

Ji Jingrong asked Yin Lingzhu what to do.

Yin Lingzhu thought for a moment, took out her phone, and called the police.

The police came and took all four of them to the police station.

The two brothers were detained.

Yin Lingzhu and Ji Jingrong gave simple statements and were released.

They took a taxi. After experiencing tonight's events, neither had any mood to buy groceries.

When they reached the apartment entrance, Yin Lingzhu said goodbye to Ji Jingrong and was about to return to her room when Ji Jingrong called her back.

Ji Jingrong pointed to Yin Lingzhu's arm. "You should still treat your arm. I have medical supplies."

Only then did Yin Lingzhu notice a red-purple bruise extending from the outer side of her forearm to her deltoid muscle.

The injured area was on the outside, making it difficult for her to treat alone. If she left it untreated, it might delay her cooking studies.

Thinking this, Yin Lingzhu nodded and agreed to Ji Jingrong's suggestion.

Yin Lingzhu entered Ji Jingrong's room and discovered it was filled with various small items, all in a cute style.

"Does Lawyer Ji really like these things?" Yin Lingzhu picked up a small figure - a little cat holding its chest and ignoring people.

Hearing Yin Lingzhu's question, Ji Jingrong silently blushed. "Yes, I've liked these since I was little, but only bought them after I started working."

While speaking, Ji Jingrong found bandages and alcohol. She pressed Yin Lingzhu onto the sofa.

She dipped a cotton swab in alcohol and applied it to Yin Lingzhu's wound.

Yin Lingzhu didn't dare move. While the alcohol disinfected, it also brought intense stinging pain.

She could only try to ignore the feeling, and in her daze, she thought of Yan Si.

She recalled the stunning feeling of meeting Yan Si for the first time, and her own heartbeat at that moment.

"Done."

Ji Jingrong's voice sounded, pulling Yin Lingzhu back to reality.

Yin Lingzhu saw that her arm was actually wrapped in bandages.

"Your main injury is on the triceps, it's quite serious." Following Yin Lingzhu's gaze, Ji Jingrong guessed what she was thinking and said in advance.

"You can come to me tomorrow to change the dressing, or you can go to the hospital." Ji Jingrong packed up the medical kit while speaking.

"Then I'll trouble Lawyer Ji." Yin Lingzhu said politely.

She was about to return to her apartment when she suddenly thought of something.

"Lawyer Ji, what's your gender?" Yin Lingzhu knew she was asking a very impolite question.

But the books said that married people should maintain a certain distance from the opposite sex.

She was afraid Yan Si would be unhappy if she got too close to others.

Ji Jingrong's movement paused. "I'm a Beta."

Hearing this answer, Yin Lingzhu breathed a sigh of relief. As long as she wasn't an Omega, it was fine.

"Then get some rest early. Sweet dreams." Yin Lingzhu waved to Ji Jingrong and gently closed the door.

Ji Jingrong held the medical kit, lost in thought for a long time.

Returning to her apartment, Yin Lingzhu prepared to take the vegetables she bought yesterday and learn to cook again following tutorials.

On the other side, Yan Si was at You Xiaoxiao's house.

You Xiaoxiao showed Yan Si photos in her hand - images of Yin Lingzhu going to the company in the evening.

"She's preparing to break her contract with her original company, and there might even be a lawsuit." You Xiaoxiao pointed to Yin Lingzhu in the photo.

"You should take this opportunity to sign her to your company."

Yan Si didn't understand You Xiaoxiao's suggestion and asked directly.

"There doesn't seem to be any benefit. Yin Lingzhu can't bring any profit to the company." Yan Si's tone was flat, rationally analyzing gains and losses.

"Put her under your watch so you can feel at ease, and if she doesn't follow the contract, you can respond early." You Xiaoxiao still didn't trust Yin Lingzhu.

"Alright then. I also have contracts in my apartment. I'll have her sign tonight." Seemingly convinced by You Xiaoxiao, Yan Si agreed.

Just after Yin Lingzhu finished cooking, she heard the sound of the door opening. Looking over, it was indeed Yan Si returning.

Yin Lingzhu brought the dishes she made to the table, preparing to invite Yan Si to eat.

Yan Si acted as if she hadn't seen anything and walked directly back to her bedroom.

Yin Lingzhu saw Yan Si come out with a contract in her hand.

"Sign this." Yin Lingzhu heard Yan Si's voice say.

Yin Lingzhu obediently walked over and signed her name in the blank space on the contract.

After finishing writing, she originally wanted to invite Yan Si to eat at the dining table.

But seeing that Yan Si had no intention of staying, she had already taken the contract and was preparing to leave.

Yin Lingzhu said nothing more.

Hearing the sound of Yan Si closing the door, she sat dejectedly on the sofa, feeling a wave of sourness in her heart.

Yin Lingzhu glanced sideways at the bandage on her arm, feeling that the pain from the alcohol earlier was nothing compared to the heartache she felt now.

She looked at her hands again, where obvious oil splatter marks were visible. Her fair hands had been damaged like this.

In front of Yan Si, Yin Lingzhu couldn't feel confident at all, completely different from her true personality.

Time Skip

Time flew by, and eleven months later.

Yin Lingzhu was petting the folded-ear cat¹ in her hands, feeling very troubled.

"Knock—knock." The sound of knocking came. Yin Lingzhu knew it was Ji Jingrong and got up to open the door for her.

"What's wrong with you?" Ji Jingrong saw a face full of worry and couldn't help asking.

She touched the cat in Yin Lingzhu's hands, already knowing the answer in her heart. "It's because of your wife again."

"Mm, she hasn't come for a long time." Yin Lingzhu's voice was muffled.

"Why did you come to find me? Why didn't you send me a message?" Seeing the person standing in front of her, Yin Lingzhu suddenly thought of this question.

Ji Jingrong looked at her and opened her mouth helplessly. "I sent you messages and called you, but you didn't respond to me."

Only then did Yin Lingzhu remember that she had put her phone on silent.

"Then what did you want to see me about?"

Ji Jingrong took the cat into her arms. "Its doctor - I went through great effort to get an appointment."

"Let's talk in my apartment." Ji Jingrong sighed.

Even after almost a year, she had never entered Yin Lingzhu's room.

The two discussed in Ji Jingrong's apartment all afternoon, while the cat played around the room.

"Then it's settled. Tomorrow night we'll take Tiantian² for treatment." Ji Jingrong's voice carried worry.

"I don't know what your wife was thinking, giving you a Ragdoll cat³. Doesn't she know how fragile Ragdoll cats are?"

Hearing her words, Yin Lingzhu frowned but didn't speak. She couldn't find any words to refute.

"It's fine. She's very busy, maybe she just didn't know." Yin Lingzhu forced a smile, making excuses for Yan Si.

Ji Jingrong rolled her eyes at her. "I don't know who has you so bewitched."

Yin Lingzhu had only said she was married, not mentioning whom she married.

Footnotes: ¹ Folded-ear cat (折耳猫) - Scottish Fold cats, known for their distinctive folded ears. However, this breed often suffers from genetic health issues related to cartilage defects.

² Tiantian (田田) - The name given to the cat, literally meaning "field" but used as a cute pet name.

³ Ragdoll cat (布偶猫) - A breed known for being docile and beautiful but also quite delicate and prone to health issues, requiring careful care.